

Trinity University — School of Business
BAT 2302 – Fundamentals of Information Systems
Summer 2026 Course Syllabus

Course Information

Instructor	Ian Liu
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Department	Finance and Business Analytics
Course Location	Online via Zoom: https://trinity.zoom.us/j/97322217362 (Passcode: 928738)

Office Hours

Day	Time	Format
After Class	1 Hour After Each Class	Zoom

Textbook

Management Information Systems: Managing the Digital Firm by Kenneth C. Laudon, Jane P. Laudon, and Carol G. Traver. Pearson Publishing, 18th edition.

Course Objectives

By the end of the semester, students will be able to:

- Understand and fluently use terminology, concepts, and theories related to information systems.
- Analyze and effectively communicate features, capabilities, limitations, and development trends of information technologies and systems.
- Understand and critically evaluate the social, political, psychological, or economic impact of digital information (e.g., social networks, privacy, copyright, crowdsourcing).
- Develop scripts to restructure and analyze data.
- Use software to efficiently organize and query data in personal and enterprise relational databases.
- Use visualization software to facilitate decision-making and knowledge management.

Student Performance Evaluation

Component	Weight
Exam 1	15%
Exam 2	15%
Exam 3	15%
5 Homework Assignments	25%
6 Data Camp Practices	25%
Participation	5%
Total	100%

Exams

Three exams will be given during the semester to evaluate student knowledge of topics covered in lectures, readings, and assignments. Details about each exam will be provided one week prior to the exam date.

Make-up exams will not be offered unless the absence is due to a University-approved excuse (see Excused Absences). Students **MUST** inform the instructor **BEFORE** the exam time about an anticipated excused absence so a makeup can be arranged. Notifications sent after exam time will lead to a 10% grade deduction. Missing a single exam without pre-arranging alternatives will automatically result in a grade of 0.

Homework Assignments

Students will complete FIVE individual assignments outside of class:

- Coding in a Python Jupyter Notebook.
- Coding in Python to interact with a database, retrieve data, summarize data, and generate visualizations.
- Creating a customized AI bot from scratch.
- Writing a series of SQL statements to retrieve information from an MS SQL Server database.
- Using Tableau to visually convey information contained in a dataset.

Details regarding each assignment will be provided during the semester. Late submissions will lead to grade reduction (see Late Submission Consequences below).

DataCamp Assignments

Students will need to complete SIX mini-courses/practices offered via Datacamp, which is online interactive learning and coding platform. An invitation link can be found in Modules to join the virtual learning environment on DataCamp.

Participation

This category is evaluated based on class attendance and student engagement during class time. Each method below is optional, but students should take advantage of these opportunities as much as possible to earn sufficient participation points. Once the participation score reaches 100, students are welcome to continue participating, but 100 is the maximum.

- Answering designated questions in class — 5 points each.
- Uploading class notes to Canvas — 10 points each. This is the instructor's way of checking attendance and may be requested randomly at the end of class. Electronic notes may be uploaded directly; handwritten notes should be photographed, converted to PDF (e.g., using Genius Scan or Microsoft Office Lens), and uploaded.

Grading Scale

Grades will be assigned strictly according to the following table:

Grade	Percent	Point Value
A	93–100	4.000
A-	90–92.9	3.667
B+	87–89.9	3.333
B	83–86.9	3.000
B-	80–82.9	2.667
C+	77–79.9	2.333
C	73–76.9	2.000
C-	70–72.9	1.667
D+	67–69.9	1.333
D	60–66.9	1.000
F	Below 60	0.000

Note: Only students with a 100% participation record will be considered for rounding up final grades, and rounding is limited to no more than 0.5 point. Otherwise, grades are rounded only to the first decimal place (e.g., 89.9, 93.5).

Late Submission Consequences

Late submission of assignments (homework, class notes, etc.) will lead to a grade reduction proportional to how late the submission is:

Submission is later for	Grade Reduction
≤ 24 hours	10%
> 24 hours but ≤ 48 hours	20%
> 48 hours but ≤ 72 hours	50%
> 72 hours	100%

General Class Policies

- Course slides only outline each point covered. Detailed material is delivered in lecture — attend class, listen carefully, and take notes.
- Class attendance is required. Per University policy, students with 4 or more absences may be dropped from the course before the withdrawal deadline, receive an F, or otherwise have their final grade affected.
- Do not wait until the last minute to submit assignments — network or computer issues can occur.
- Professional writing is expected for all assignments, exams, and presentations. Reading assigned materials is part of the required learning effort.
- All assignments must be submitted via Canvas in the specified format. Shared Google Docs, Sheets, or Slides are not accepted — download and submit the file in the required format.
- When making travel arrangements, avoid all exam dates.
- Notices and announcements are sent by email through Canvas. Check your email at least once daily.
- Use your Trinity email address when contacting the instructor. Emails from non-Trinity addresses will not receive a response.
- Review class material before attending office hours so you know what to ask.
- Per University workload guidance, faculty are not expected to respond to email after hours or on weekends. Emails sent before 6 pm will receive a same-day reply; emails sent after 6 pm or on weekends should not expect a same-day reply. On Mondays and Wednesdays the instructor teaches three classes from 9:05 am to 3:45 pm — replies on those days will typically come in the evening.

Academic Integrity

All students are covered by a policy that prohibits dishonesty in academic work. Under the Honor Code, a faculty member will (or a student may) report an alleged violation to the Academic Honor Council, which investigates, adjudicates, and assigns punishment within established guidelines if a violation is verified.

Students are required to pledge all written work submitted for a grade: *“On my honor, I have neither given nor received any unauthorized assistance on this work,”* followed by their signature. The pledge may be abbreviated as “pledged” with a signature.

Electronic Recordings of Course Instruction

To accommodate inevitable student absences, the instructor will record missed classes upon request. If you anticipate missing class, notify the instructor in advance. Recordings will be posted on Canvas after class.

Class recordings are not a substitute for attending class — reasonable excuses are still required for absences.

All classroom instruction, including student participation, is subject to recording and dissemination on Canvas. Recordings are available only to enrolled students for online learning and review. Students are expressly prohibited from capturing or copying classroom recordings by any means; violations are subject to disciplinary action. Instructors who wish to use a recording outside of class must obtain written consent of any students who are personally identifiable in the recording.

Excused Absences

Per the Faculty Handbook (6[B]VII), students who are absent from class to observe a religious holiday, who are absent while participating in a University-sponsored dramatic production, or who are off campus officially representing the University (e.g., intercollegiate athletics, debate tournaments, tours) will be excused from classes.

Absence Due to Illness

Students who are sick will also be excused from classes. False claims about illness may be regarded as a violation of the Academic Honor Code, which prohibits falsification of academic records.

Students who experience a family emergency that interferes with academic performance are encouraged to contact Dr. Kyle Gillette, Associate Vice President for Academic Affairs: Student Success.

Use of Generative AI

AI can be a great tool to assist you, but it must be used responsibly. Using AI to evaluate and improve your work is acceptable; having AI do the work for you is not.

Permitted Uses

- Brainstorming and refining ideas.
- Finding information on your topic.
- Drafting an outline to organize your thoughts.
- Checking grammar and style.
- Generating an example to give you an idea of where to start or what the end result should look like.

Prohibited Uses

- Completing group work assigned to you, unless your group mutually agrees the tool may be used.
- Writing a draft of a writing assignment.
- Writing entire sentences, paragraphs, or papers to complete class assignments.

All use of AI tools must be properly documented and cited per University academic honesty policies. Any assignment found to have used AI tools in unauthorized ways may receive a 0 or be required to be resubmitted.

Student Accessibility Services

If you have a documented disability and need accommodations, privately speak with the instructor after class or email the accommodation request issued by the ATC early in the semester. All discussions remain confidential. You must be registered with Student Accessibility Services (210-999-7411 or atc@trinity.edu) before accommodations can be provided. Students with extended test time will usually be directed to the Accommodated Testing Center, Halsell 227, at a designated date and time.

Title IX / Sexual Misconduct Reporting

All faculty and staff must report incidents of sexual harassment or sexual misconduct to the Title IX Coordinator. Information shared with the instructor about sexual misconduct or harassment will be reported to the Title IX Coordinator. This report ensures access to resources, supportive measures, and options for resolution — it does not mean a formal complaint process will begin. You remain in control of how you choose to engage with the Title IX process.

If you or someone you know has experienced sexual misconduct, including sexual harassment, you are encouraged to share that information directly with the Title IX Coordinator or one of the individuals designated as a confidential resource on campus.

Academic Support Resources

Trinity faculty hold students to the highest academic standards and know that the best students seek help when necessary. The following resources support your academic success:

- Office of Academic Advising — explore academic opportunities, identify goals, plan your degree, register, and navigate your experience.
- Academic Support — time management, study skills, test anxiety, note taking, supplemental 1:1 tutoring.
- Office of the Dean of Students — student support, development, and engagement through Student Care Referral, student conduct, and leadership development.
- Center for Experiential Learning & Career Success — major exploration, career guidance.
- Counseling Services — mental health concerns, interpersonal relationships, identity development.
- Health Services — physical health concerns and care.
- Quantitative Reasoning and Skills Center — tutoring for quantitatively demanding coursework.
- Student Accessibility Services — accommodations for a diagnosed disability.
- Wellness Programs — nutrition, sleep, stress management.
- Writing Center — starting a paper, finding a thesis, drafting and editing.

All campus resources for students can be found on TigerHub.

Course Schedule

Note: Topic dates may shift over the course of the semester depending on class performance and participation.

Class	Date	Topic	Reading / Module
1	5/21	Course Syllabus, and Introduction to Business Information Systems	Course Syllabus, Chapter 1
2	5/26	Global E-Business and Collaboration	Chapter 2
3	5/28	IT Infrastructure – Hardware & Software	Chapter 3, chapter 5
4	6/2	Internet and Wireless	Chapter 5, chapter 7
5	6/4	Exam 1	
6	6/9	Database and Information Management	Chapter 6
7	6/11	Fundamental Python	DataCamp
8	6/16	Intermediate Python	DataCamp
9	6/18	Business Analytics and Visualization in Python and Python for SQL Query Basics	Chapter 12, DataCamp
10	6/23	Exam 2	
11	6/25	Business Intelligence and Analytics	Chapter 11, DataCamp
12	6/30	Introduction to AI and Build Your First AI Bot	
13	7/2	IS Security and Data Ethics Tableau(Won't be covered in class)	Chapter 8, DataCamp
14	7/7	Exam 3(aka. Final Exam)	